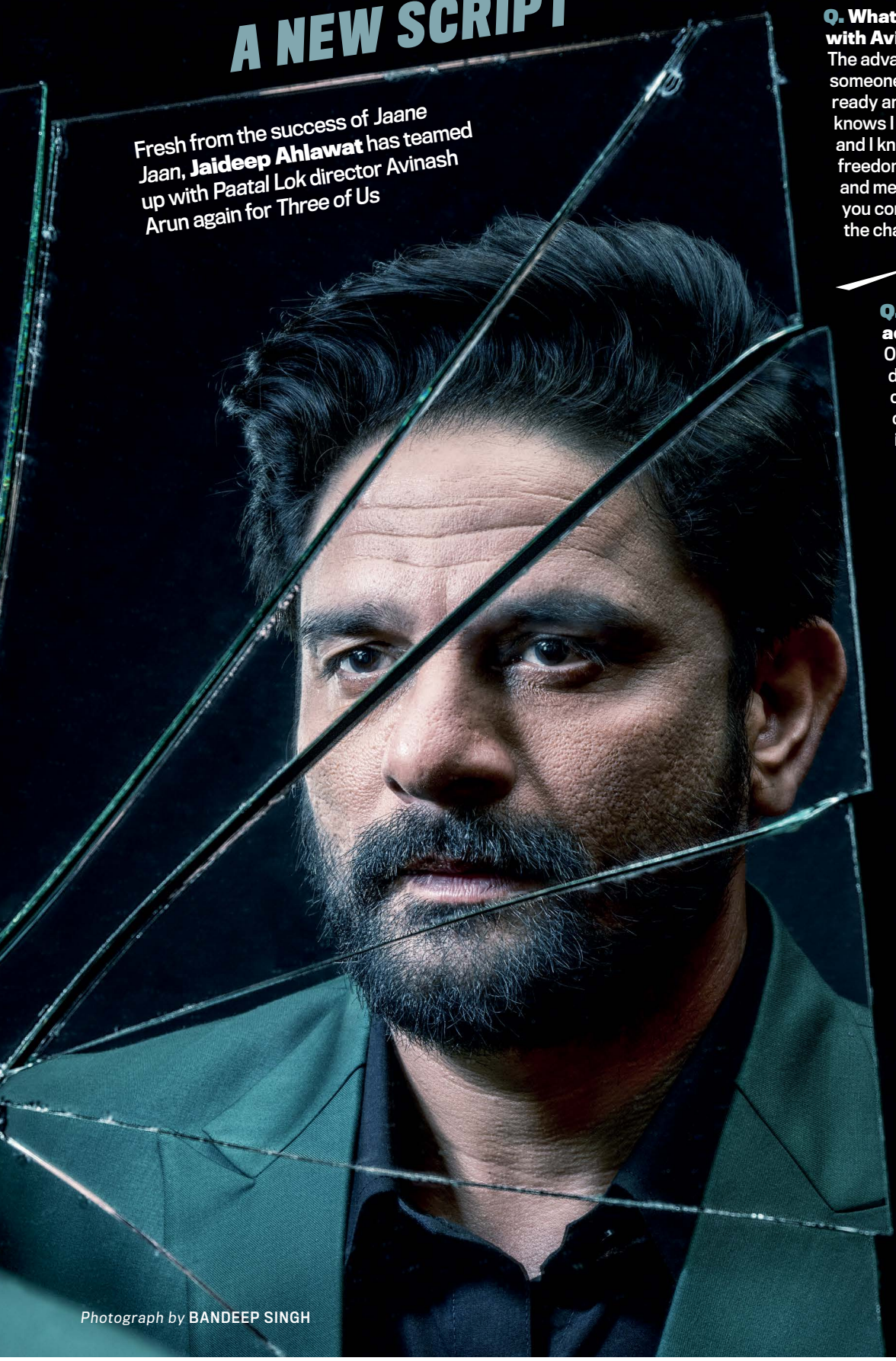
A NEW SCRIPT

Fresh from the success of Jaane Jaan, **Jaideep Ahlawat** has teamed up with Paatal Lok director Avinash Arun again for Three of Us



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Q. What was collaborating with Avinash Arun again like?
The advantage of working with someone again is that there is already an understanding. Avinash knows I like challenging myself and I know he will allow me the freedom to take my sensibilities and merge them with his. When you combine forces, the edge on the character becomes sharper.

Q. You don't like the 'OTT actor' tag... Why?
OTT and theatre may be different platforms, but the craft is the same.... Yes, cinema has a different impact on the big screen. But whether you are shooting for OTT or the big screen does not change the way you work on set.

Q. What draws you to a role?
The first and foremost is the script. It has to be honest. Yes, most of my onscreen roles have been heavy-intensity characters, but whatever the role may be, I think of how much it will challenge me.

Q. What's in the future?
I'm really craving an out-and-out comedy. Being a romantic hero in a Karan Johar directorial is another one on my wishlist! I also hope to direct in the future. As regards my next releases, there is a short film with Fatima Sana Shaikh, directed by Shashank Khaitan. Ali Abbas Zafar's *Khaali Peeli* is also interesting.

with Aarti Kapur Singh